

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



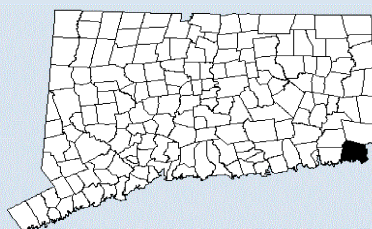
Stonington School District

Dr. Van Riley, Superintendent • 860-572-0506 • <http://www.stoningtonschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	7
Enrollment	1,901
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,638
Total Expenditures ¹	\$40,807,690

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	948	49.9	48.4
Male	953	50.1	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	37	1.9	5.2
Black or African American	22	1.2	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	124	6.5	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	107	5.6	4.0
White	1,601	84.2	49.9
English Learners	10	0.5	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	519	27.3	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	293	15.4	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	104	11.2	*	*
Male	125	13.5	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	36	29.5	*	*
White	168	10.8	18	1.1
English Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	118	24.8	12	2.1
Students with Disabilities	56	21.5	8	2.5
District	229	12.4	24	1.2
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 116

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stonington School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	133.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	12.2
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	29.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	64.6
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.0
School Level	11.8
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.8
Support Staff	3.8
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	6.2
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	15.0
School Nurses	9.5
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	97.3

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	205	100.0	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.0	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	8	*
White	94	66.7	128	89.5
English Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	16	38.1	28	77.8
Students with Disabilities	16	72.7	24	88.9
District	104	65.0	150	87.7
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	23	57.5
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	80	81.6
Other Health Impairment	60	74.1
Other Disabilities	0	0
Speech/Language Impairment	23	92.0
District	198	71.7
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	43	2.2	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	18	0.9	1.1
Intellectual Disability	8	0.4	0.5
Learning Disability	98	5.1	5.8
Other Health Impairment	81	4.2	3.3
Other Disabilities	17	0.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	31	1.6	1.9
All Disabilities	296	15.3	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	16	5.4	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	32	10.8	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$24,283,182	\$11,686	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$2,280,265	\$1,168	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$1,993,257	\$1,021	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$1,784,587	\$914	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$2,458,112	\$1,259	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$840,670	\$430	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$4,446,206	\$2,277	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$2,108,573	\$1,027	\$1,159
Food services	\$183,445	\$94	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$429,394	\$220	\$151
Total	\$40,807,690	\$19,638	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$3,925,213	33.8	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,374,867	11.8	11.1
Other Salaries	\$987,387	8.5	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$1,610,748	13.9	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$211,120	1.8	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$2,935,530	25.3	22.5
Supplies	\$61,168	0.5	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$500,783	4.3	7.2
Equipment	\$5,037	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$141	0.0	0.1
Total	\$11,611,994	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		28.5	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	92.2
State	5.2
Federal	2.5
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	8	*
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	48	95.8
Students with Disabilities	27	81.5
District	162	95.7
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	93.5	77	49.7
Male	89.2	84	47.7
Black or African American	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino	*	6	*
White	93.3	146	51.4
English Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	83.3	17	21.8
Students with Disabilities	67.3	*	*
District	91.2	161	48.6
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	82.6	92.8
Male	68.1	88.7
Black or African American	N/A	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	75.4	92.7
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61.2	83.3
Students with Disabilities	47.8	*
District	74.4	91.0
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	12.4%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	21.0%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	76.7%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	48.6%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		87.5%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		95.7%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		89.8%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		74.3%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		57.0%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	89.8%	4.2%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Stonington School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Despite the challenges presented by the pandemic and the implementation of the hybrid and fully remote learning models, Stonington Public Schools District Improvement Plan continues to focus on the development and implementation of standards-based, student-centered curricula in all disciplines preK-12. The district improvement plan includes a three-year acceleration of learning initiative; the goals of improvement in student growth and performance especially focus in mathematics where performance lags. Improving district special education programs are centered on the management of student behaviors and supporting resources and staffing for the area of individualized reading instruction. Primary teachers, reading specialists, and special education teachers continue to engage in professional development with Enhanced Core Reading Instruction to support Tier I and II instruction in foundational reading skills. A cohort of teachers at the elementary and middle school level are also trained in the delivery of the Wilson reading program. Other reading programs including S.P.I.R.E., Just Words, and Rewards Intermediate and Secondary address the targeted needs of students who struggle with various components of reading. The district has expanded and added specialized programs, throughout the elementary schools and middle schools, to meet the needs of students with Autism as well as students who need specialized behavioral support classrooms. Classroom programs include individualized curriculum, BCBA support services, access to assistive technology, and mental health support services. A Learning Annex provides educational programming for students returning from outside placements and also secondary students not finding success in the traditional classroom setting. Students are provided small group instruction in addition to a boat building experience at Mystic Seaport. Administration and staff use a variety of social media platforms, newsletters, websites, and other electronic communication as a means of keeping parents informed on all student-related matters. The district administration provided an increased level and frequency of communications throughout the year to keep families informed on the dynamic teaching and learning environment. All K-12 board approved curriculums are posted on the district website for families to access and use to support learning at home. Due to the impact of the pandemic, many workshops, special events, and meetings are held virtually to inform parents on school-wide initiatives and programs. The high school aggressively targets attendance issues by providing daily increased mentorships for at-risk students to improve attendance in school. Attendance Success Plans for students are developed and implemented before they are identified as chronically absent. A part-time family engagement specialist makes home visits to re-engage chronically absent students as well. A software program that communicates attendance concerns to parents has been effective to improve attendance concerns. Middle school teams track attendance and meet with families and students on a regular basis to improve attendance and address any school avoidance issues. At the elementary level, social workers and administration meet with parents to discuss attendance concerns.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Stonington Public Schools continues to foster student understanding and respect for diverse populations who attend our schools and live in our community. Work specific to Diversity, Equity and Inclusion (DEI) expanded this year based upon the District's Call to Action drafted in July 2020. Professional learning for all educators and administrators continued throughout the year to foster an anti-biased, anti-racist learning community across the school system. Stonington alumni have helped inform this work and contributed to the development of learning opportunities for staff members. At the elementary level, there are positive behavioral support programs that center on developing core values. Through classroom studies, students develop an appreciation for cultural perspective, learning about varied family customs and traditions. The elementary and middle schools implement the Second Step curriculum in grades K-8 to support social-emotional learning and the development of pro-social behaviors. To supplement the Second Step Curriculum, topics of identity, stereotypes, equity and racism are also addressed through the K-12 VOICE program. The appreciation of other cultures and the value of fluency in a second language is reflected by the significant number of the graduating class (twenty-five percent) at Stonington High School earning the Seal of Biliteracy. The school-based health center works with local agencies to provide programs for students and families on health and nutrition, which include mental and physical well-being activities along with healthy food and meal preparation based on simple, low-cost ingredients. Mental health staff work with students to instill common language and positive behavioral expectations. The use of technology expands access to local and global information, while music and art instruction support cultural studies. Students participate in a variety of service projects to support needs found within our community. The district is participating in the Connecticut Teacher Residency Program, an alternate route to certification that embraces a new approach to attract and retain teachers of color in Connecticut schools. A candidate has been identified to work at West Vine Street School in the upcoming school year.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Stonington's Board of Education dictates that comparable resources are distributed to each school in the district. Students in each grade, regardless of school assignment, receive equal access to these resources. Budgets are developed annually to address school and district needs. Consideration is given to enrollment figures, class-size, programs, student performance and growth data, curriculum, and district initiatives. The process of budget development at the district level is informed by building administrators' recommendations and contributions to budget discussions. Equitable requests are made to the Board of Education. Monies for supplies, texts, and other academic materials are budgeted on a per-pupil basis. In January, the Superintendent presents a proposed budget to the Board of Education. This is formulated based upon input from building level and district level administrators, as well as input from school-based teams. Public meetings are conducted in January and February as the Board of Education studies financial figures and builds its budget for presentation to the Board of Finance. Input from the community is welcomed and a town-wide referendum is hosted in May.